Lists, in practice

TC1037 · Algorithmic Thinking · Session 12 · max, min and mean over a column

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Tecnológico de Monterrey · Campus Querétaro · Group 510

First, an apology — and a standing invitation

I cancelled tutoring sessions without telling you.

Urgent work came up, I dealt with it, and I lost track of the clock. That is on me, not on you, and it is not how I want this to run.

If you were one of the people left waiting: I am sorry.

Next week I am open.

Book a slot — the link is in the Canvas announcement.

Bring something specific: your midterm paper, the code that will not run, your dataset. Fifteen minutes on a real problem beats an hour of nodding.

Due dates — tonight, Sunday, Tuesday

When	What	What counts as done
Tonight 23:59	**Deliverable 1** `entrega1.xlsx`	An Excel table from a real source. **30–50 rows**, up to **10 columns: 5 text 5 numeric**. In pairs. One upload pe team.
Sunday 23:59	**Homework 6 + Lab 6**	Lists. Both on Canvas now.
Tuesday, in class	**Quick exam 5**	Lists. Same format as the other four.

As of this morning: zero of you have uploaded Deliverable 1. Each missed or late stage costs **5 points** off the project — and the project is 15 % of the course.

Deliverable 1 — the whole thing, on one slide

Where to get data

kaggle.com/datasets · datos.gob.mx · datacatalog.worldbank.org

Or a real company that lets you use its numbers — **a family business counts**, and is often the better project.

The shape

30–50 rows. Up to 10 columns: about five text, about five numeric. You need both kinds — the text columns are what you will group by, the numeric ones are what you will average and plot.

How to not waste the weekend

1. Pick a subject you actually want an answer about.
2. Download the table. Open it. *Look* at it.
3. Delete the columns you will never ask about. Ten is a ceiling, not a target.
4. Save it as `entrega1.xlsx` and upload it as a pair.

Next Friday you write the questions you will ask this table. Pick data that has questions in it.

Where we stopped on Tuesday

```
speeds = [100, 90, 140, 80]

speeds[0]          # 100
speeds[3]          # 80
len(speeds)        # 4
speeds[len(speeds) - 1]    # 80
speeds.append(60)
```

One name, many values, **in order**.

Counting starts at **0**, so the last index is `len(xs) - 1` — and `speeds[4]` on a four-item list is an `IndexError`, not an empty box.

`append()` is how a list grows *inside* a loop.

Today: the three things you will do to every column of your dataset.

Three questions, one shape

```
def mean(xs):
    total = 0
    for x in xs:
        total = total + x
    return total / len(xs)

def maximum(xs):
    best = xs[0]
    for x in xs:
        if x > best:
            best = x
    return best
```

Same four beats every time:

1. start an accumulator
2. walk the list
3. update it
4. `return` it — outside the loop

Minimum is `maximum` with `<`. Write it in thirty seconds and you have three of the five statistics your project needs.

Two traps, both of them yours already

The return inside the loop

```
for x in xs:
    total = total + x
    return total    # <- stops
```

It returns after the *first* value. One indentation level decides whether you get the answer or the first item.

best = 0

```
best = 0
for x in temperatures:
    if x > best: best = x
```

Fine until a column is all negative — then the maximum of `[-3, -8, -1]` comes back `0`, a number that is not in your data. Start from `xs[0]`, not from zero.

Out loud, before I scroll: what does `maximum([-3, -8, -1])` return with `best = 0`?

Both of these cost marks on the midterm. The second is the `n == 0` case wearing a different hat: *what does this do on the awkward input?*

Python already has these — and you are still writing the loop

```
sum(xs)          # the total
max(xs)          # the largest
min(xs)          # the smallest
len(xs)          # how many

sorted(xs)       # a NEW sorted
    list
xs.sort()        # changes xs
    itself
```

Yes, they exist. From week 9 you will use them, and pandas will give you better ones.

This week you write the loop, because in three weeks a library will hand you a column and you need to know what it is doing to it. The loop is the thing being assessed — not the answer.

And now you know why `sum = 0` as a variable name was marked: you just destroyed the function, for the rest of the program.

`sorted()` hands back a new list; `.sort()` changes the one you were given and returns `None`. Same lesson as `print` versus `return`.

A row is a list — and it need not be all numbers

```
fila = ["Norte", "Laptop", 340,
    12]

fila[0]       # "Norte"
fila[2]       # 340
len(fila)     # 4

"Laptop" in fila      # True
"Tablet"  in fila     # False
```

A list may hold text and numbers at once. That is not a curiosity — it is **one line of your** `entrega1.xlsx`: two text columns and two numeric ones.

Out loud: what does `sum(fila)` do?

`TypeError` — you cannot add `"Norte"` to a number. You never total a *row*. You pick a **column** first, and total that.

A table is a list of rows

```
tabla = [
  ["Norte", "Laptop", 340, 12],
  ["Sur",   "Mouse",   90,  4],
  ["Norte", "Tablet", 560,  8],
]

tabla[0]         # the first row
tabla[0][2]      # 340
len(tabla)       # 3 rows

ventas = []
for fila in tabla:
    ventas.append(fila[2])
# [340, 90, 560]
```

Two indices: `tabla[fila][columna]`. The first picks the row, the second picks the cell.

Those four lines **pull a column out of a table** and hand you the flat list you already know how to work with:

`mean(ventas)` → `330.0`
`maximum(ventas)` → `560`

This is your spreadsheet. Nothing else about it is new.

The question you will actually ask: “which branch sells most?”

```
ventas_norte = []
for fila in tabla:
    if fila[0] == "Norte":
        ventas_norte.append(fila[2])

print("Norte:", sum(ventas_norte))
```

An `if` inside a `for`, over rows instead of numbers.

This is deliverable 2. “Which branch sells most? Which product? Who are the best clients?” — every one of those is this shape: filter the rows by a text column, collect a numeric column, run a statistic.

Out loud: what does this print for the table above?

`Norte: 900` — 340 and 560, not 90.

If you want it: every cell, not just one column

```
for fila in tabla:
    for celda in fila:
        print(celda)
```

A loop inside a loop: the outer one walks the rows, the inner one walks the cells of *that* row. It runs `rows` × `columns` times — 12 for our table.

You do not need it this week. You will in week 8, and when you do, the *how many times* sentence is the whole point.

Why this is the project, not an exercise

```
# entrega1.xlsx, one column
ventas = [120, 340, 90, 560]

def estadistica_descriptiva(xs):
    return (mean(xs), maximum(xs)
    ,
            minimum(xs), len(xs),
            total(xs))
```

The final program needs **five descriptive statistics** over your data. You have just written them.

In week 9 pandas hands you the column instead of you typing it. Nothing else changes — same functions, same `main()`, same labels.

That is why tonight's upload matters: without a table, there is no column, and without a column there is nothing to run this on.

A list is a column.

A loop is a question you ask it.

Tonight 23:59 — `entrega1.xlsx`, in pairs

Sunday 23:59 — Homework 6 and Lab 6

Tuesday — Quick exam 5, in class

And book a tutoring slot. I am free next week and the link is in Canvas.